

Harbor Identity Modernization Architecture Decision Compendium

Meridian Group | Harbor Identity Modernization | Synthetic enterprise project artifact

Executive Context

Harbor Identity Modernization is a cybersecurity transformation initiative at Meridian Group. The goal is to modernize enterprise identity, provisioning and access governance. The program is designed as an operating-model change, not just a technical implementation.

The project team includes IAM Operations, Application Owners, Security Architecture, Service Desk, Client Security SMEs. Decision records, meeting transcripts and working documents intentionally overlap so a long-term memory system can preserve both current truth and historical rationale.

Business Requirements

The solution must improve consistency, traceability and decision quality without creating hidden systems of record. Key first-phase principles are: Applications migrate in readiness-based waves; Privileged access receives stronger controls; Non-SCIM applications may remain outside phase 1.

Users need understandable status, accountable ownership, explicit exception paths, and enough provenance to explain why a decision or result exists. Material changes must be reflected in acceptance criteria and operating documentation.

Architecture and Dependencies

The solution is composed of HR / Lifecycle Feed, Enterprise Directory, Provisioning Layer, Policy Engine, SSO Gateway, Access Audit. Component boundaries exist so source-system authority, project-owned processing and downstream user experiences remain explicit.

Cross-project dependencies include ATLAS: pilot authentication dependency; NOVA: account-team authorization model. Shared dependency timing is managed through enterprise architecture and project steering rather than by silently duplicating shared capabilities.

Delivery and Risk

Primary risks include legacy provisioning gaps, role mapping ambiguity, Atlas timing pressure, privileged-access control change, directory cleanup. These risks are treated as business and operating-model concerns in addition to technical concerns because each can change adoption, support effort or the reliability of business decisions.

A dependency delay does not automatically move the project milestone. The project manager first evaluates resequencing, degraded-mode operation, scope protection and temporary controls before seeking a formal decision.

Governance and Traceability

Material decisions retain rationale, alternatives, owner and supersession history. Older assumptions are preserved because they explain why the project evolved. Current truth should be determined from accepted decision status and provenance, not simply the newest timestamp.

Temporary exceptions require an owner and review condition. Shared SMEs resolve enterprise-standard questions; local teams may not redefine shared semantics purely to unblock a milestone.

Decision Summaries

1. Migration waves: Applications migrate in waves based on criticality and provisioning readiness. Rationale: A readiness-based sequence reduces operational risk and avoids blocking the program on difficult legacy apps. 2. RBAC: Role-based access is baseline, with governed exceptions. Rationale: Common role models simplify access review while allowing controlled exceptions for legitimate edge cases. 3. Atlas bridge: Harbor provides an interim SSO bridge for the Atlas pilot. Rationale: Atlas can pilot without waiting for the full identity modernization while still using enterprise controls. 4. Legacy apps: Legacy apps without SCIM are not forced into phase 1. Rationale: Custom provisioning for every legacy app would overload the first migration wave and increase risk. 5. Privileged access: Privileged accounts require step-up controls before migration. Rationale: Administrative access has materially higher blast radius and needs stronger assurance before cutover.

Rejected Patterns

Avoid project-local master data, undocumented exception handling, hidden permission bypasses, premature expansion of scope and deleting superseded decisions. These patterns reduce traceability and transfer cost to support teams.